

FlyingSalem

Fly over the real Salem, Massachusetts

User Manual — every feature, every screen, every control

Version 20261013.1 · 2026-10-18 · Destructive AI Gurus, LLC

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Part 1 — Welcome

What FlyingSalem is, what you need, and the one-minute version.

1.1 What FlyingSalem is

FlyingSalem lets you fly over the real Salem, Massachusetts, and the towns around it — Beverly, Marblehead, Peabody, Danvers, Swampscott and their neighbours. Every hill, building, street and stretch of shoreline is built from public survey data: the state's laser survey of the ground, its building outlines, its roads, rivers and lighthouses, and the Massachusetts Historical Commission's inventory of historic places.

You fly a witch on a broomstick. The app opens already flying a sightseeing tour of Salem's waterfront, so you can simply watch. Touch the screen at any moment to take the controls, and hand them back whenever you like. Name cards tell you what you are looking at — Salem's historic buildings, its churches and civic buildings, its burial grounds and its lighthouses — and, if you choose, every place in our Salem visitor guide: shops, restaurants, ghost tours and more.

1.2 What you need

- An Android phone or tablet with **Android 8.0 or newer** and **OpenGL ES 3.0** graphics.
- FlyingSalem from **Google Play**.
- Nothing else: no account, no sign-up and no internet connection. Everything the app shows is inside the app when you install it.
- FlyingSalem plays **sideways (landscape)**. Hold the device either way round; the picture turns with it.

1.3 How it works, in one minute

1. **Open FlyingSalem.** It starts flying the sightseeing tour by itself. Sit back and watch.
2. **Put your thumb anywhere on the screen and drag** to fly: left or right to turn, down (toward you) to climb, up to dive — like an airplane's control stick.
3. **Let go.** If you don't touch anything for 25 seconds, the tour takes over again. To hand back straight away, tap the ↻ button.
4. **Use the six round buttons on the right** to change the camera, jump anywhere with the map, choose which places get name cards, hand back to the tour, turn the sound off, and see where the data comes from.
5. **Use the SPEED slider on the right edge** to go faster, slower, or stop in mid-air.

1.4 Your privacy

FlyingSalem never asks you for a permission. The copy Google Play installs does carry one, which Google Play adds and Android grants without asking: "Google Play license check". This is the app's own privacy statement, word for word, as it appears on the sources screen (section 3.11):

> This app has no internet permission. It sends nothing to us, collects nothing, and contains no advertising, analytics or tracking of any kind. To confirm that this copy came from Google Play, it may ask the Google Play Store app on your phone, which checks with Google under Google's own terms and privacy policy. Because some US states require it, the app may also ask the Google Play Store app for your age range and, if a parent supervises your account, whether they approved. The answer stays on your phone, is used for nothing else, and is not kept. The entire world it draws is already inside the app when you install it.

Part 2 — The features

What FlyingSalem can do. Part 3 goes through every control in detail.

2.1 A real place, built from the survey

The world is a square about **18.4 km (11½ miles)** on each side, centred on Salem. In it:

- **The ground** — hills, valleys and shoreline shaped from the state's 2021 laser survey, with a height every 16 metres.
- **101,292 buildings**, each placed, sized and shaped from the survey, with walls and roofs.
- **Trees**, grown wherever the survey measured tree canopy.
- **Roads and railways** laid on the ground, and the bridges that carry them over the rivers.
- **Water, beaches, marsh, woods, fields and built-up areas**, painted from the state's land-use survey.
- **Six lighthouses**: Derby Wharf Light, Fort Pickering (Winter Island) Light, Hospital Point (Range Front) Light, Hospital Point Rear Range Light, Bakers Island Light and Marblehead Light.
- **Haze** near the ground that thins as you climb, so the whole area opens up from height.

2.2 The sightseeing tour

When you open the app — and whenever you hand back — the tour flies for you. It starts at Derby Wharf and visits the area's lighthouses, its bridges and its waterside places, then loops round and starts again, for as long as you like.

- It flies at about **66 knots** on its way to a lighthouse or a bridge, and about **100 knots** on its way to the other stops.
- It flies low: about 300–350 ft past lighthouses and bridges, about 700 ft over the place names, and never less than about 300 ft above the ground beneath.
- The readout at the top left says `✈ SIGHTSEEING — FlyingSalem` and names the next stop: `toward: Derby Wharf`.
- On the go-to map (section 3.10) the tour's stops are the yellow dots with names.

2.3 Flying it yourself

- **Touch anywhere** on the screen (except the buttons and the slider) and you are flying. You don't need to touch the flyer itself.
- The point where you first touch becomes the centre of an invisible stick. Drag away from it to steer. A faint ring shows how far the stick goes, and a gold knob shows where you are.
- **Drag right** to bank right and turn right; **drag left** to turn left.
- **Drag down** (toward you) to raise the nose and climb; **drag up** to lower it and dive — just like an airplane's control stick.
- The further you drag, the harder it turns or climbs. The full effect is at the edge of the ring.
- If you haven't used the speed slider, your speed follows the stick: about 150 knots in level flight, easing to about 95 knots in a full climb or dive.
- You can't fly into the ground — you always stay at least about 150 ft above it — and you can climb to **6,000 ft**, where the whole area fits on the screen.

- **Let go**, and 25 seconds later the tour takes over (unless you've used the speed slider — see 2.4).
- At the **edge of the area** the tour takes over and turns you back toward Salem, and the screen says `Auto Pilot Engaged`.

2.4 Speed — from a standstill to 777 knots

- The **SPEED slider** on the right edge sets your speed, from **0** at the bottom to **777 knots** at the top.
- The bottom of the scale is stretched out: halfway up is 194 knots, so the slow sightseeing speeds get most of the slider.
- Touching the slider takes the controls from the tour, just as touching the screen does. When you let go, the speed stays where you put it.
- **At 0 you hover in mid-air.** You can still turn, and the nose can tilt much further — down to 80° — so you can look straight down at the town beneath you.
- The number above the slider is your speed in **knots**, the same unit as the readout at the top left.

> **The slider remembers its setting until you close the app.** Once you've used it, the tour no longer takes over by itself after 25 seconds — tap **↻** when you want the tour. And the next time you take the controls, even after handing back, you fly at the slider's speed. If you left it at 0, you'll slow to a stop. The readout tells you: `speed held · ↻ for the tour` or `stopped · ↻ for the tour`.

2.5 Five ways to watch

The camera button switches between five views, in this order: **chase** (from behind), **wing** (alongside), **eye** (straight ahead, with no flyer in the picture), **tower** (a slow circle round you, well out, so the town is the star) and **map** (looking down from high above). Section 3.9 shows each one.

2.6 Name cards and dots

- **Coloured dots** mark places on the ground up to about 2 km away. The colour says what kind of place it is (section 3.8). Lighthouses and National Historic Landmarks never fade; other dots fade gently with distance.
- **Name cards** name the places near you and ahead of you: the name on top, and underneath what kind of place it is. A thin line runs from each card down to its place.
- The name-cards button chooses what is named: **historical**, **all** or **none**.
- **Lighthouses always glow and show their names**, whichever you choose.
- Places you are flying directly over get cards too, whichever way you are heading.

2.7 Go anywhere with the map

The go-to button opens a map of the whole area. Pinch to zoom, drag to look around, and **tap anywhere on land or water to fly straight there**. You arrive about 800 ft above the ground there, level and still flying.

2.8 Sound

You are flying a broom, so there is no engine — only **the wind** rushing past and **the town below**.

- The wind gets louder and brighter the faster you go. At top speed there is only wind.

- The ground has its own soft sound, which changes with what is beneath you: open sea, surf on a beach, marsh, woods, fields or town. It blends from one to the next as you cross, and fades away as you climb.
- **Places speak as you approach them**: seagulls at the lighthouses, bells at landmarks and churches, moans at the burial grounds, rattles at the witch shops, a clank as you cross a bridge, and more (section 3.13).
- Every sound is made by the app as you fly. There are no voices and no recordings.
- The sound button turns it all off and on.

2.9 A busy sky

You are not alone up there. **Six other broom riders**, each in a different hat and coat, fly errands across the area from burial ground to burial ground: flying, circling down, landing, sitting a while and launching off again.

2.10 Built to keep flying

- **Automatic detail.** The app watches how smoothly it is drawing and sets its own detail level — low, medium, high or native — to keep the flight smooth. The bottom-right corner shows the result.
- **It recovers from a frozen picture by itself.** If the picture ever stops moving for two seconds, the app rebuilds its drawing and carries on, in the same place, within a few seconds.
- **The screen stays on** while FlyingSalem is open, because it is made to be watched.
- **Leaving pauses it.** Switch to another app and the flight and the sound stop; come back and they carry on where you were.

> FlyingSalem works your device's graphics hard and keeps the screen on. On a long flight, keep an eye on the battery, and close the app when you have finished.

Part 3 — Every screen and control

All pictures are from a Lenovo tablet. On a phone, the same things appear in the same places, sized to the screen.

3.1 Opening the app

- Tap the **FlyingSalem** icon. The app fills the screen edge to edge; the device's own bars are hidden. Swipe in from an edge to see them for a moment.
- While the world loads, the screen is plain grey-blue for a moment, with the buttons already in place. Then you are flying the tour.
- It always starts the same way: **the tour**, the **chase** view, **historical** name cards and the **sound on**. FlyingSalem doesn't remember your settings from one visit to the next.
- There is no welcome screen and nothing to sign up for, and FlyingSalem never asks you anything. Google Play may ask one question of its own: whether to share your age range (see 1.4). That screen is Google's. Whatever you answer, FlyingSalem works the same.

3.2 The flight screen at a glance



The tour flying toward Fort Pickering (Winter Island) Light, in the chase view, with historical name cards.

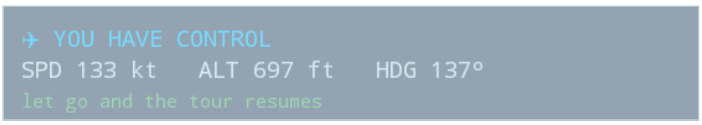
1. **Who is flying** — the tour (yellow) or you (blue). 3.3
2. **Speed, altitude, heading.** 3.3
3. **The tour's next stop**, or how to rejoin it. 3.3
4. **A name card** — name, then the kind of place, with a line to its dot. 3.8
5. **A lighthouse card** — always shown, in gold. 3.8
6. **A dot** — a place without a card. 3.8
7. **Your flyer.** 3.5
8. **Camera** — the caption is the current view. 3.6, 3.9
9. **Go to** — opens the map. 3.6, 3.10
10. **Name cards** — historical, all or none. 3.6, 3.8
11. **Tour** — auto or manual; tap to hand back. 3.6
12. **Sound** — on or muted. 3.6, 3.13
13. **Sources** — credits, privacy, licences. 3.6, 3.11
14. **The SPEED slider**, speed in knots on top. 3.7
15. **Where the world comes from.** 3.4
16. **Smoothness** (frames per second) and **detail level**. 3.4

3.3 The readout, top left

Three lines, updated about three times a second.



The tour is flying. Line 1 is yellow. Line 3 names the next stop.



You are flying. Line 1 turns blue. Line 3: let go, and the tour takes over again after 25 seconds.



You are flying at a speed you set with the slider. The tour won't take over by itself; tap ↻.



You have stopped in mid-air with the slider at 0. Tap ↻ for the tour.

Line 1	`✈ SIGHTSEEING — FlyingSalem` — the tour is flying. `✈ YOU HAVE CONTROL` — you are.
Line 2	`SPD` your speed in knots · `ALT` your altitude in feet above sea level (not above the ground beneath you) · `HDG` your compass heading in degrees: 000 north, 090 east, 180 south, 270 west.
Line 3	`toward: …` the tour's next stop · `let go and the tour resumes` · `speed held · ↻ for the tour` · `stopped · ↻ for the tour`

3.4 The bottom lines and the notice



Bottom left — where the world comes from. It is built from the state's laser survey (MassGIS LiDAR) and road inventory (MassDOT), baked into the app, and needs no network. Full credits: 3.11.



Bottom right — how smoothly it is drawing, in frames per second, and the detail level the app has chosen: `low`, `medium`, `high` or `native` (full resolution). The lower levels draw a smaller picture and stretch it to fill the screen, which keeps the flight smooth on less powerful devices.



Auto Pilot Engaged — shown just above the bottom edge for 3 seconds whenever the tour takes over: after you tap ↻, after 25 seconds without a touch, or when you reach the edge of the area.

3.5 The flying stick



Dragging: the faint ring is the stick's full reach; the gold knob is your thumb.



Touching the flyer itself makes it glow. It flies exactly the same either way.

- **Anywhere is the stick.** The whole screen is the control, in every camera view, whether or not the flyer is on screen. Only the six buttons and the slider do something else.
- **It is centred where you touch.** You don't need to look at your thumb. The ring's radius is a little under a quarter of the screen's height; drag to the ring for the full effect.
- **Left and right** bank and turn the flyer, up to a bank of about 49°. At full stretch a complete circle takes about 8½ seconds.
- **Down and up** raise and lower the nose: up to about 24° in normal flight, and up to 80° when you have stopped with the slider.
- **Lift your thumb** and the stick returns to centre: the flyer levels its wings and its nose.
- **Two fingers work together.** You can hold the slider with one and fly with the other.
- Touching the screen takes the controls straight away. The readout turns blue and the Tour button reads **manual**.

3.6 The six buttons

The buttons run down the right-hand side. The word under each one shows what it is set to **right now**. A tap anywhere on a button, or just around it, counts. A button tap never steers the flyer.

Button	The word under it	Tap it to…
	**chase · wing · eye · tower · map** — the view you are in. 	**Camera.** Switch to the next view, in that order, round and round. The view changes at once. See 3.9.

	**go to**	**Go to.** Open the map of the whole area; tap anywhere on it to fly there. See 3.10.
	**historical · all · none**   The pin is an outline for **historical**, solid for **all**, and struck through for **none**.	**Name cards.** Switch to the next choice, in that order. The cards change straight away. See 3.8.
	**auto** — the tour is flying **manual** — you are 	**Tour.** Hand straight back to the tour. It heads for whichever stop is nearest, so it doesn't fly back across the harbour to pick up where it was. `Auto Pilot Engaged` shows for 3 seconds. (If the tour is already flying, a tap just points it at the nearest stop, with no notice.)
	**sound** — the speaker has waves **muted** — the speaker has a cross 	**Sound.** Turn all of FlyingSalem's sound off, or back on. It doesn't change your device's volume.
	**sources**	**Sources.** Open the sources screen: where the world comes from, the software inside, the privacy statement, the licence agreement and the software licences. See 3.11.

3.7 The SPEED slider



Left: the tour at 66 knots, never touched — notch and fill agree. Right: the tour flying at 99 knots while the notch stays at 0, where it was last set.

- **The number at the top** is your speed now, in knots.
- **The filled part** of the track is the speed you are actually flying.
- **The bright notch** is the speed you asked for. Notch and fill differ for a few seconds while the flyer speeds up or slows down.
- **The 0 and the bar across the foot** mark a full stop, not just "slow".
- **S P E E D** is written down the track so you can find it at a glance.
- **Tap or drag anywhere along the track** to set a speed. You don't have to hit the thin track exactly; the area around it counts too.
- **Let go** and the speed stays where you put it.

Notch position	The number reads (knots)	Feels like
Bottom	0	Hovering — look around, look down
A quarter of the way up	48	A slow, low drift over the rooftops
(The tour's own speeds)	66 / 101	Sightseeing
Halfway	194	Brisk — crossing town in under a minute
Three-quarters	437	Fast
Top	777	Across the whole area in under a minute

Touching the slider takes the controls from the tour. For what happens after that, see the note in 2.4: until you close the app, the slider's setting is kept, the tour no longer returns by itself, and taking the controls again flies at that speed.



A speed set and held.



Stopped: SPD 1 kt and falling to 0.



Stopped and looking down: drag up to lower the nose, here over downtown Salem.

3.8 Name cards, dots and colours

A name card

The **top line** is the place's name. The **second line** is the kind of place, as our guide files it — for example `Historic Buildings · districts`, `Worship`, `Tour Companies · ghost tours` — or `active light` for a lighthouse. A thin **line** runs from the card down to a **badge** on the place itself.

- **Gold and bold:** lighthouses and National Historic Landmarks.
- Places in the **historical** group (below) have cards in the same colour as their dot, so card and dot match. Other places have cards with a white name and a green second line.
- Cards are clearest within about half a kilometre and fade out by about 2½ km.
- When cards would overlap, the further one steps up out of the way. Its line still leads to its place. A card that can't find room is left out, but its place keeps its dot.
- Cards favour places **ahead** of you and the most significant places. Up to about 40 cards show at once, plus the lighthouses, plus up to 8 places directly beneath you, within about 300 m, whichever way you are heading.
- The choice is refreshed about three times a second, so cards come and go as you fly.

The badge on the place

Mark inside the badge	Kind of place
a cross	Worship
a gable (roof peak)	Historic Buildings
a peaked hat	Witch Shop
fork tines	Food Drink
a tree	Parks Rec
a single bar	Lodging
a small ring	everything else, including lighthouses

The three choices



historical *(outline pin)*



all *(solid pin)*



none *(pin struck through)*

The same moment from the same spot, stopped over Salem's waterfront, in each choice.

Choice	Name cards for…	Dots for…
historical (where it starts)	The historical group: from our Salem guide, its **Historic Buildings**, **Civic** buildings, places of **Worship** and **Emergency** services, plus the **burial grounds** from the state's historic inventory — 239 places in all.	The same 239 places.
all	**Every place in our Salem guide** — 1,979 places in 22 kinds, from shops and restaurants to ghost tours and parks — plus the burial grounds.	The same places as its name cards: our guide's places and the burial grounds. The go-to map counts 2,016.
none	**No name cards** — except the lighthouses, which always show.	The historical group's 239 places, so you can still see where they are.

> **Lighthouses always glow and announce** in all three choices: a gold card, a dot that never fades, and seagulls as you pass.

What the colours mean

Lighthouses and the state's historic inventory

pale gold	Lighthouse
bright gold	National Historic Landmark
amber	Listed individually
orange	Part of a historic district

Our Salem guide, by kind of place

gold	Historic Buildings
sage	Historic Landmarks
purple	Witch Shop
periwinkle	Worship
slate	Civic
orange-red	Food Drink
tan	Shopping
pink	Entertainment
green	Tour Companies
leaf green	Parks Rec
teal	Lodging
blue	Education
rose	Healthcare
grey-green	Finance
stone	Offices · Apartment Building
grey	Auto Services · Fuel Charging · Parking · Services
light grey	Emergency · Transit

The names in the right-hand column are as they appear on the cards' second line.

3.9 The five camera views

Tap the camera button to move to the next view. Every view except **eye** eases after the flyer, so in a hard turn the flyer swings across the picture and then settles — the way an aircraft looks from outside.



chase *— from behind and a little above, looking where you are heading. Dive and you see what you are diving at.*



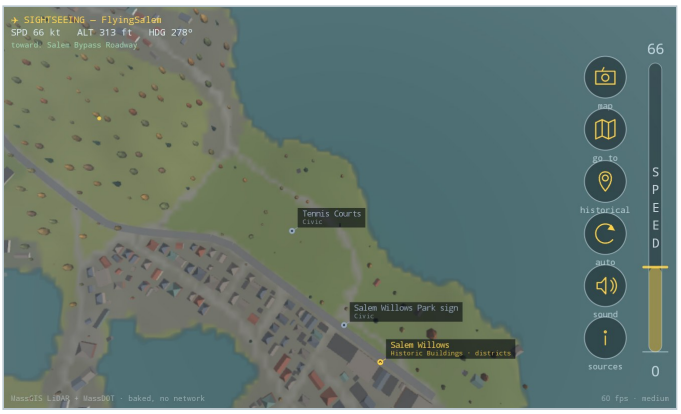
wing *— alongside, off one side, so you see your flyer in profile against the town.*



eye *— straight ahead from the front of the broom. There is no flyer in the picture, and the horizon stays level even in a turn.*



tower *— a slow circle round you, well out and above, about once every half-minute. The town is the star.*



map *— looking down from about 1,400 ft above you, with the ground laid out like a map.*



The tower view across the harbour to Derby Wharf: the lighthouse's gold card reads active light.

3.10 The go-to map



The map opens centred on you (the blue arrow) at 4× zoom. Yellow dots with names are the tour's stops.



Dragged south to downtown Salem. The small dots are places from the current name-card choice, in their colours.

What's on the map

- A **north-up plan** of the whole area, drawn from the same survey as the 3-D world, so the coastline matches exactly: water dark blue, roads pale, railways brown, woods and marsh dark green, beaches sand, built-up areas grey and fields olive.
- **You** — a blue arrow pointing the way you are heading. It moves as you fly.
- **The tour's stops** — yellow dots with names. Where names would pile up, some are left off, but every dot is still there to tap.
- **Places** — small coloured dots, following the name-card choice, so the map shows what the world shows.
- Along the top: `pinch to zoom · drag to pan · tap to fly there`.
- Along the bottom: the zoom, the width shown, and how many places are marked — for example `4× · 4.6 km · 239 historic POIs · back to close`. The word changes with the name-card choice: *historic*, *all* (2,016) or *unnamed* (for **none**).

Using it

Do this	And this happens
Pinch with two fingers	Zoom from 1× (the whole 18.4 km area) to 24×.
Drag with one finger	Look around. You can't drag beyond the edge of the area.
Tap a spot	**Fly there.** The map closes and you are over that spot. A tap within about a finger's width of a tour stop goes exactly to the stop.
Tap outside the square map, or press Back	Close the map without moving.

Arriving

You arrive about 800 ft (250 m) above the ground at that spot, level, still flying, and facing the middle of the area. Whoever was flying keeps flying: if the tour was in charge, it carries on from the stop nearest your new position; if you were, you still are. Sounds start fresh for the new place.



*With **all** chosen, the map marks 2,016 places: our guide's places and the burial grounds.*



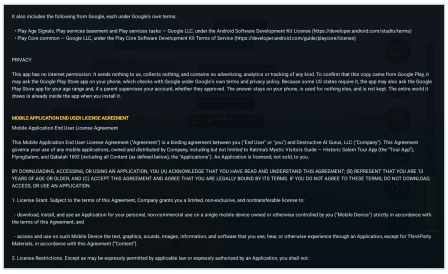
A moment after tapping downtown Salem: the tour carries on from here, toward Derby Wharf.

3.11 The sources screen

Tap the **sources** button (the **i**). A dark screen opens over the flight, which carries on behind it. It always opens at the top.



The top: the world's sources and the software inside.



Further down: the privacy statement and the start of the licence agreement.



Near the end: the notices Google supplies with its libraries.

From top to bottom it holds:

1. **FlyingSalem** and **Copyright © 2026 Destructive AI Gurus, LLC**.
2. **THE WORLD** — every public survey the world is built from, listed exactly as the data files inside the app declare them, with the agencies that publish them.
3. **SOFTWARE** — the open-source parts inside the app and the licences they come under.
4. **PRIVACY** — the statement quoted in section 1.4.
5. **MOBILE APPLICATION END USER LICENSE AGREEMENT** — the licence agreement, in full.
6. **APACHE LICENSE, VERSION 2.0** — in full.
7. **NOTICES GOOGLE SUPPLIES WITH ITS LIBRARIES** — in full.
8. At the very end: `Tap anywhere to return`.

Drag to scroll. **Tap anywhere** — or press **Back** — to return to the flight. While the screen is open, touches don't steer the flyer.

3.12 The Back button

- With the **sources screen** open, Back closes it.
- Otherwise, with the **map** open, Back closes the map.
- With neither open, Back leaves FlyingSalem. Opening it again starts the tour afresh.

3.13 Sound, in detail

What you hear	When
Wind	Always. Louder and brighter with speed. Banking changes it too. At a standstill it is at its quietest.
The ground	A soft sound that depends on what is beneath you — sea, beach, marsh, woods, fields or town — blending as you cross from one to the next. It fades as you climb; high up you hear only wind.
Places speaking	As you approach them (table below), about a second and a half before you arrive, however fast you are going. While you stay near a place it speaks again every few seconds. Nothing on the ground speaks when you are more than about 1,700 ft above it.

Place	Sound	Speaks…
Lighthouses	seagulls	when you come within about 340 m (further ahead when you are fast)
Burial grounds	a moan	
National Historic Landmarks	a bell	
Witch shops	a rattle	
Bridges	a clank	
Churches and other places of worship	a bell	when you come within about 190 m
Food and drink, entertainment	a clatter	
Parks	rustling leaves	
Transit	a rumble	

- So that downtown doesn't become one wall of noise, places take turns — and when you fly fast, they come by as a quick patter.
- Memorials make no sound. Out of respect for the people executed in the witch trials of 1692, neither do the places most closely tied to them, such as Proctor's Ledge and Rebecca Nurse's grave.
- The **sound** button mutes everything. Leaving the app stops the sound; it comes back when you return.

3.14 Messages you may see

On screen	Meaning
`✈ SIGHTSEEING — FlyingSalem`	The tour is flying.
`✈ YOU HAVE CONTROL`	You are flying.
`toward: …`	The tour's next stop.
`let go and the tour resumes`	Let go, and the tour takes over after 25 seconds.
`speed held · ↻ for the tour`	You set a speed; the tour returns only when you tap ↻.
`stopped · ↻ for the tour`	You are stopped in mid-air.

`Auto Pilot Engaged`	The tour has just taken over (shown for 3 seconds).
`MassGIS LiDAR + MassDOT · baked, no network`	Where the world comes from.
`44 fps · low` (for example)	Smoothness, and the detail level the app chose.
`pinch to zoom · drag to pan · tap to fly there`	How to use the map.
`4× · 4.6 km · 239 historic POIs · back to close`	The map's zoom, width and count.
`Tap anywhere to return`	The end of the sources screen.
On the sources screen, a line beginning `⚠ Part of the bundled data could not be opened on this device`	Part of the world could not be loaded, and the app is running without it. Please tell us, using the contact details on FlyingSalem's Google Play page.
On the sources screen, a line beginning `⚠ The bundled data did not declare its sources`	A fault in that copy of the app. Please tell us the same way.

Part 4 — Step by step

Short recipes for the things people most want to do.

4.1 Watch the tour

1. Open FlyingSalem and put the device down. The tour flies by itself.
2. Tap the camera button until it reads **tower** for a slow circling view, or **wing** to watch your flyer against the town.
3. Read the name cards as they pass. The top-left line tells you where the tour is heading next.

4.2 Take the controls and fly a circle

1. Put your thumb anywhere in the middle of the screen. The readout turns blue: **YOU HAVE CONTROL**.
2. Slide your thumb to the right, out to the faint ring, and hold it there. The flyer banks and turns right; a full circle takes about 8½ seconds.
3. Slide back to the centre to straighten up. Drag down a little to climb, or up a little to descend.
4. Let go to level off. The tour comes back after 25 seconds (unless you have used the slider).

4.3 Jump to downtown Salem

1. Tap **go to**. The map opens, centred on you.
2. Drag the map until you can see downtown Salem, just inland of Derby Wharf, where the dots are thickest.
3. Tap the spot. You are there at once, about 800 ft above the ground.
4. If the tour was flying, it carries on from the nearest stop. To stay put, use the slider (4.4).

4.4 Stop in mid-air and look straight down

1. Tap the bottom of the SPEED slider, at the **0**. The flyer slows to a stop over a few seconds. The readout says **stopped · ↻ for the tour**.
2. Put your thumb on the screen and drag **up**. Stopped, the nose can tilt down to 80°, so you look straight down at the streets beneath you.
3. Drag left or right to turn on the spot and look around.
4. Let go to bring the nose back to level. You stay where you are until you set a speed or tap **↻**.

4.5 Climb high and see the whole area

1. Push the SPEED slider well up. You climb much faster at speed.
2. Hold your thumb down (toward you) at the edge of the ring to climb at the steepest angle.
3. Keep climbing until the readout shows about **ALT 6000 ft**, the highest you can go. Tap the camera button to **eye** or **tower** for the widest view.
4. Bring the slider down and drag up to come back down. You can't hit the ground.

4.6 Hand back to the tour

1. Tap ↻ — the fourth button, captioned **manual** while you are flying.
2. **Auto Pilot Engaged** appears for 3 seconds, the caption changes to **auto**, and the tour heads for the nearest stop.

4.7 Show every place in the guide

1. Tap the name-cards button (the pin) once. Its caption changes from **historical** to **all**, and the pin turns solid.
2. Fly over downtown Salem: shops, restaurants, ghost tours, museums and more get name cards alongside the historic places.
3. Tap once more for **none** — dots only — and again to return to **historical**.

4.8 Read the credits and the licence

1. Tap **sources** (the **i**, the last button).
2. Drag up to scroll through the sources, the privacy statement, the licence agreement and the software licences.
3. Tap anywhere, or press Back, to return to the flight.

Part 5 — Help

Troubleshooting, a one-page reference, and the credits.

5.1 Troubleshooting

If…	Try this
It looks a little soft or blocky	The app has chosen a lower detail level to keep the flight smooth on your device (bottom-right corner). It changes by itself as conditions allow.
The picture stops moving	Wait a few seconds: the app rebuilds its drawing by itself and carries on from the same place. If it doesn't, close FlyingSalem and open it again.
There's no sound	Check that the sound button reads **sound**, not **muted**, and that your device's media volume is up. Places on the ground are silent when you are more than about 1,700 ft above them.
The tour won't come back by itself	If you have used the speed slider, the tour waits for you. Tap ↻.
When I take the controls, I slow to a stop	The slider is still set to 0 from earlier. Drag it up to the speed you want.
I'm not seeing any name cards	Check the name-cards button: **none** shows only dots (and lighthouses). Cards appear for places within about 2 km, mostly ahead of you. Fly closer or lower.
The tour took over in the middle of my flight	Either 25 seconds passed without a touch (and you hadn't used the slider), or you reached the edge of the area.
It won't turn upright (portrait)	FlyingSalem plays sideways only. Turn the device either way round.
My battery is going down	FlyingSalem keeps the screen on and works the graphics hard. Close it when you have finished.
It asks me to sign in, or for a permission	It never does. FlyingSalem has no accounts and never asks you for a permission.
Google Play asks whether to share my age range	That question is Google Play's, not FlyingSalem's, and only some accounts see it. Whatever you answer, FlyingSalem works the same and keeps nothing.
It tells me to get the app from Google Play	Google Play could not confirm this copy. Install FlyingSalem from Google Play.

5.2 Quick reference

To…	Do this
Fly	Drag anywhere: right/left to turn, down to climb, up to dive
Level off	Let go
Speed up / slow down	SPEED slider, right edge — up is faster
Stop in mid-air	SPEED slider to 0
Look straight down	Stop, then drag up
Change the view	Camera button: chase → wing → eye → tower → map

Go somewhere	**go to**, then tap the map
Choose name cards	Pin button: historical → all → none
Hand back to the tour	↻ (or wait 25 s, if you haven't used the slider)
Mute	Speaker button
Credits, privacy, licences	**sources** (the i)
Close the map or sources screen	Tap outside the map / tap anywhere on sources, or press Back
Leave the app	Back, with nothing open

Number	Value
The area	18.4 km (11½ miles) square · 101,292 buildings · 6 lighthouses
Tour speeds	about 66 kt on the way to lighthouses and bridges, about 100 kt otherwise
Your speed range	0–777 knots with the slider
Height	never below about 150 ft above the ground; up to 6,000 ft
The tour takes over	25 s after your last touch (until the slider is used), or at the edge of the area
Name cards	within about 2 km; up to about 40, plus lighthouses, plus up to 8 directly beneath you
Map zoom	1× to 24× (opens at 4×)

5.3 Credits

FlyingSalem's world is built from other people's public survey work, and we credit it gladly. This is the credit block for FlyingSalem's store listing, reproduced word for word. The same sources, as the app's own data declares them, open from the **sources** button.

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DATA SOURCES

The world in this app is built from public survey data. It is not our work,
and it is reproduced here with thanks:

  • MassGIS 2021 QL1 LiDAR (DTM/DSM) — Commonwealth of Massachusetts / USGS 3DEP
  • MassGIS structures and LiDAR-derived building massing
  • MassGIS outline25k, landuse, majorhydro, geonames, lighthouses
  • MassDOT Road Inventory; MassGIS trains
  • MACRIS — Massachusetts Historical Commission historic inventory
    (National Register / Local Historic District designations), via MassGIS
  • Points of interest curated by Destructive AI Gurus, LLC

MassGIS — Bureau of Geographic Information, Commonwealth of Massachusetts.
MassDOT — Massachusetts Department of Transportation. 3DEP — U.S. Geological
Survey. MACRIS — Massachusetts Historical Commission.

Historic designations shown in this app are records of public inventory. They
describe buildings, not the people who live in them.

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